

THE LANDLORD'S GAME · VARIANT 1 OF 5

1904 Original

Circular 40-space track
BOARD

2–6
PLAYERS

This is the ruleset as described in US Patent 748,626, granted January 5, 1904. It predates houses, Chance cards, and auctions. Players begin by drawing lot tickets rather than purchasing lots as they land, and the game ends after all players complete five circuits of the board.

1904 Patent — board layout

SETUP

- ♦ Each player begins with \$500.
- ♦ Shuffle the 22 lot tickets. Players draw one at a time, taking turns, until 12 tickets in total have been taken. Remaining tickets are returned to the Wages box.
- ♦ All checkers start on MOTHER EARTH.
- ♦ Determine first player by highest dice throw.

RULES

Movement: On each turn, throw both dice and move forward the combined number of spaces. Follow the rule for the space landed on.

MOTHER EARTH: Receive \$100 wages from the Wages box each time this space is reached or passed. Recorded on a tally sheet.

Lot spaces: If a player lands on a lot for which they hold the lot ticket, other players landing on that lot pay rent to the ticket holder at the lowest marked price. If the landing player holds no ticket for that lot, they may purchase it at the highest marked price (paid to the Public Treasury). If two players land on the same lot, the second pays half rent. A third player cannot occupy — they must stop one space before and count their throw one less.

Absolute Necessities (Food, Fuel, Shelter, Clothing): Pay \$5 to the Public Treasury.

No Trespassing: Player goes to Jail. Remains there until throwing a double on a subsequent turn or paying a \$50 fine to the Public Treasury.

Railroad spaces: Pay \$5 to the Railroad fund. Throwing a double on a Railroad space grants a pass: the player may jump once between railroad spaces when passing one in normal movement.

Luxury spaces: Pay \$50 to the Public Treasury and receive a luxury ticket worth \$60 at the end of the game. This is optional — if not purchased, the player loses their move.

Franchise spaces: The first player to stop on a franchise space places a charter on it. All subsequent players pay \$5 to the charter holder whenever stopping there. Placing a charter costs nothing and the charter counts nothing at end of game.

Public Park: No payment required.

Legacy: Receive \$100 cash and a legacy ticket.

Poor House: A player with no money and no mortgageable property goes here and remains until able to resume play.

Borrowing from the Bank: In \$100 increments. The bank takes a mortgage on property worth at least \$10 more than the amount borrowed. The player pays \$5 interest per bank note each time wages are received at MOTHER EARTH.

Player-to-player loans: Any terms agreed between the two players.

Five circuits: After completing 5 circuits of the board while clear of debt, a player may move in either direction on subsequent turns. Wages from MOTHER EARTH cease after a player completes the required number of circuits.

WINNING

The game ends when the last player passes MOTHER EARTH for the fifth time. Each player counts their total wealth:

- ♦ Lot card values (face value of each lot ticket held)
- ♦ Cash on hand
- ♦ Luxury tickets (each worth \$60)

The player with the highest total wins.

Optional variant (from the patent): Play without drawing lot tickets at start. Players purchase lots as they land on them, each beginning with \$100 instead of \$500.

ATTRIBUTION

1904 Original. Rules from US Patent 748,626, granted January 5, 1904. Designed by Elizabeth J. Magie. Public domain (patent expired 1921). Sources: US Patent 748,626 (public domain); hoelzl/L3 GitHub repository patent transcription, sourced from landlordsgame.info.

THE LANDLORD'S GAME · VARIANT 2 OF 5

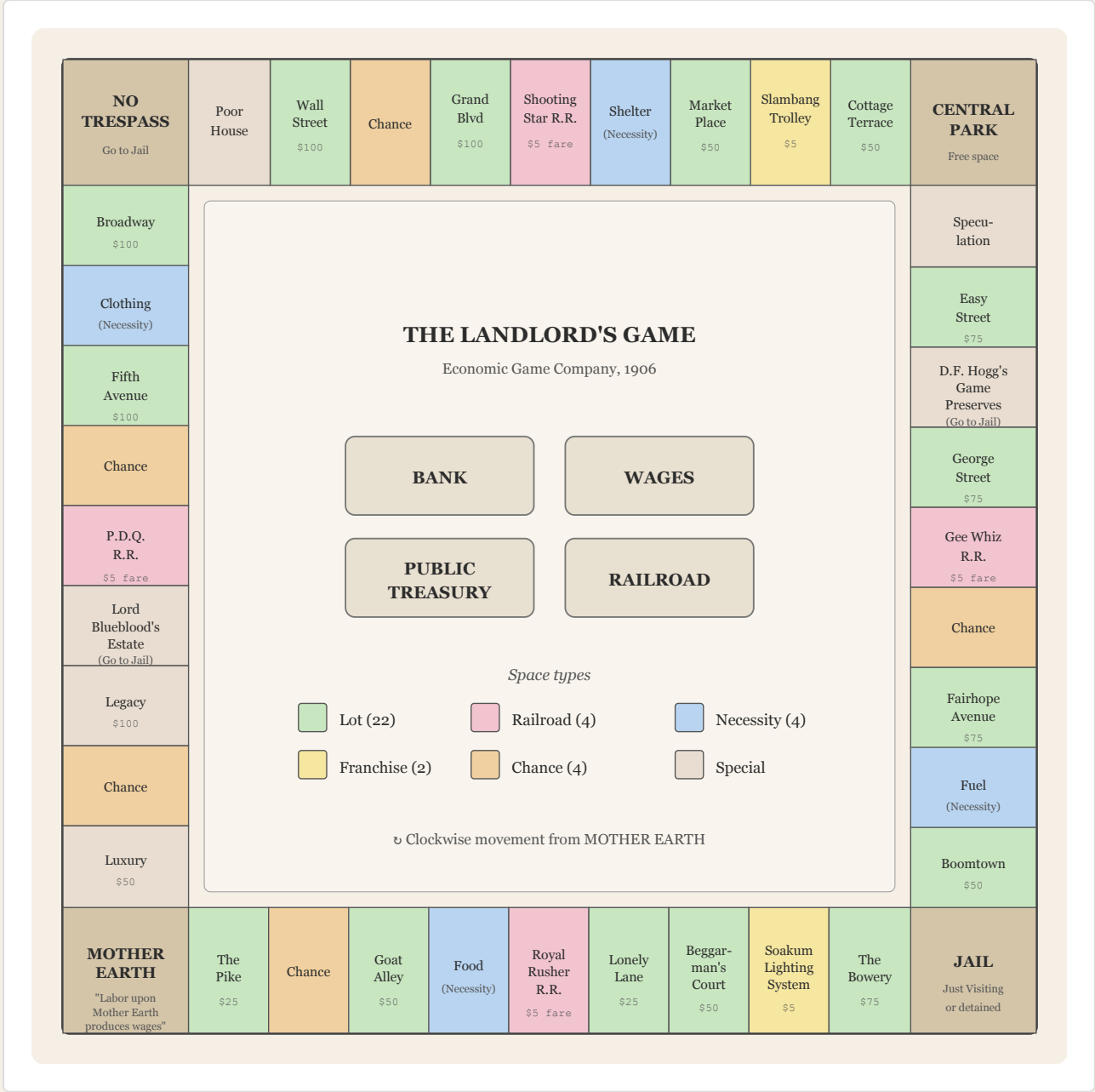
1906 Commercial Edition

Circular 40-space track
BOARD

2-4
PLAYERS

1906 COMMERCIAL EDITION

Published by the Economic Game Company of New York in 1906, this edition introduced the rules that most subsequent versions of The Landlord's Game would follow: Title Deed cards purchased by auction, houses that multiply rent, Chance cards with quotations from political philosophers, a Speculation space, and railroad monopoly pricing. It is also the edition that first included the Single Tax variant rules (see the Single Tax variant).



1906 Commercial Edition — board layout

SETUP

- ♦ Starting cash: \$600 per player (2 players), \$500 per player (3 players), \$400 per player (4 players).
- ♦ Shuffle the green Title Deed cards and deal 24 cards one at a time to the left. Each player may purchase any or all cards dealt to them at the original sale price, paid to the Public Treasury. Unpurchased cards are returned to the pack.
- ♦ All undealt money and implements are placed in the centre MISCELLANEOUS space.
- ♦ All checkers start on MOTHER EARTH.
- ♦ First player is determined by highest dice throw.

RULES

Movement: On each turn, throw the dice and move forward that many spaces. Follow the rule for the space landed on.

MOTHER EARTH: Receive \$100 wages from MISCELLANEOUS each time this space is reached or passed.

Lot spaces: If owned by another player, pay land rent to that player. If unowned, the player may purchase at the original sale price (paid to Public Treasury), or by auction: highest bidder takes the deed; the first player to land has the right of first refusal at the highest bid. If no player purchases, the landing player pays land rent to the Public Treasury.

Absolute Necessities (Food, Fuel, Shelter, Clothing): Pay \$10 to the Public Treasury.

D.F. Hogg's Game Preserves / Lord Blueblood's Estate (No Trespassing): Player immediately goes to JAIL.

JAIL: Player remains until their next turn. To exit: pay a \$50 fine to the Public Treasury, or throw a double (serves time, no fine). Maximum 3 turns in jail if the player has sufficient property.

Franchise spaces (Soakum Lighting System / Slambang Trolley): Pay \$5 to the owner. If unowned, auction as per lot spaces. Municipal Cinch: a player owning both franchise spaces raises the rate for both to \$25.

Railroad spaces: Pay \$5 fare. Railroad monopoly pricing applies based on how many railroads one player owns: 2 owned = \$10 fare, 3 = \$20, 4 = \$50. Trust: if two players together own all four railroads, they may pool them and charge \$40.

CENTRAL PARK: Free. No payment required.

Chance: Draw a red card, follow its instructions, and return the card to the pack.

Speculation: The player may refuse to move and stay in place. If they choose to play: pay \$10 ante to the Broker (the holder of the Speculation card) or to MISCELLANEOUS; then throw again. Payouts: double = win \$100, 11 = \$90, 10 = \$80, 9 = \$70, 8 = \$60, 7 = \$50, 6 = \$40, 5 = \$30. Pay 10% of winnings to the Broker. If the throw is 3 or 4: the Broker goes to Jail and the Speculation card is returned.

Poor House: A player with no money and no mortgageable property goes here. Throws to move out on the next turn.

HOUSES

Players may erect up to 3 houses per lot. House rent of \$10 per house is paid by any player stopping on that lot, in addition to land rent.

Land rent table (base / 1 house / 2 houses / 3 houses):

BASE RENT	1 HOUSE	2 HOUSES	3 HOUSES
\$2	\$4	\$8	\$16
\$4	\$8	\$16	\$32
\$6	\$12	\$24	\$48
\$8	\$16	\$32	\$64
\$10	\$20	\$40	\$80
\$12	\$24	\$48	\$96
\$14	\$28	\$56	\$112
\$16	\$32	\$64	\$128
\$18	\$36	\$72	\$144
\$20	\$40	\$80	\$160
\$22	\$44	\$88	\$176

Tax escalation: When 10 houses are on the board, taxes on Absolute Necessities double to \$20. When 25 or more houses are on the board, taxes rise to \$40.

Section doubling: When all lots in any board section (between two railroad spaces) each have at least 1 house, land rent in that section doubles. When all lots in the section have 2 houses, it doubles again. At 3 houses each, it doubles again.

WINNING

The game ends by agreement or when play cannot continue. The player with the most total wealth wins.

Scoring: every Title Deed card counts 100; every house counts 100; add cash on hand.

ATTRIBUTION

1906 Commercial Edition. Rules from the Economic Game Company edition, New York, 1906. Designed by Elizabeth J. Magie. Public domain. Source: landlordsgame.info/rules/lg-1906_rulebook.html (transcription via hoelzl/L3 public repository).

THE LANDLORD'S GAME · VARIANT 3 OF 5

Single Tax

Circular 40-space track
BOARD

2–4
PLAYERS

SINGLE TAX

The Single Tax rules appear in the 1906 Economic Game Company edition as a variant that can be entered mid-game by majority vote. They enact Henry George’s single-tax philosophy through play: land rents flow to the Public Treasury rather than individual owners, financing the progressive public acquisition of utilities, railroads, and eventually colleges, while wages rise with each increment of public wealth. The 1932 Adgame Company edition later named this process “Prosperity” and gave it a discrete win trigger; see the Prosperity variant for that version.

SETUP

As per the 1906 Commercial Edition.

Single Tax mode may be entered at any point during a 1906 Commercial Edition game when at least 2 players vote to switch. Players keep all current holdings when switching; Title Deeds become worthless once Single Tax takes effect.

RULES

Rule 1: No taxes on Absolute Necessities. Blue spaces (Food, Fuel, Shelter, Clothing) are free under Single Tax.

Rule 2: All land rent is paid into the Public Treasury for public improvements, not to individual lot owners.

Rule 3: Railroad fares and franchise rates continue to be paid to individual owners until the Public Treasury acquires them (see Rule 6). Thereafter they are free.

Rule 4: When stopping at an unimproved lot — pay full land rent to the Public Treasury; the player may then improve the lot with a house. When stopping at a lot with another player’s house — pay full land rent to the Public Treasury AND full house rent to the house owner. A player may erect a house on any unimproved lot on their turn (not only where their checker currently stands), subject to competitive bidding.

Rule 5: D.F. Hogg’s Game Preserves and Lord Blueblood’s Estate are reserved as sites for Free Colleges. The Jail penalty for landing on these spaces remains in effect until the Free Colleges are built.

Rule 6 — Public acquisition sequence, triggered by each \$50 increment added to the Public Treasury:

- 1 First \$50: buy out Soakum Lighting System — that space becomes free to all players.
- 2 Next \$50: buy out Slambang Trolley — free.
- 3 Subsequent \$50 increments: each railroad in sequence — free.
- 4 Then: Free College built on Lord Blueblood’s Estate (Jail penalty annulled for that space).
- 5 Then: Free College built on D.F. Hogg’s Game Preserves (Jail penalty annulled for that space).
- 6 Then: wages raised to \$110 at MOTHER EARTH. Each subsequent \$50 in the Public Treasury raises wages a further \$10.

Rule 7: After the first Free College is built, players stopping there may draw Education cards. Four Education cards may be exchanged for one Professor card, which counts 100 at the end of the game.

Rule 8: The Poor House is eliminated. A player who cannot afford to make a move places their checker on any Natural Opportunity space (inner corners of the board); they collect wages from that space on their next turn, pay rent to the Public Treasury, and then move out normally.

WINNING

The Single Tax mode has no individual winner. The game demonstrates Henry George's single-tax principle through play: as the Public Treasury accumulates and acquires utilities, railroads, and colleges, necessities become free, wages rise, and the burden of taxation shifts from labour and consumption to land alone. The collective end state — all utilities and railroads publicly owned, wages at their maximum, colleges built — is the win condition for all players.

ATTRIBUTION

Single Tax. Rules from the Economic Game Company edition, New York, 1906. Designed by Elizabeth J. Magie. Public domain. Sources: landlordsgame.info/rules/lg-1906_rulebook.html (transcription via hoelzl/L3 public repository); Wikipedia: The Landlord's Game (CC-BY-SA).

THE LANDLORD'S GAME · VARIANT 4 OF 5

Prosperity

Circular 40-space track
BOARD

2–4
PLAYERS

PROSPERITY

The Prosperity variant is the named, discrete-win-condition version of Elizabeth Magie's Anti-Monopolist gameplay. It first appeared under this name in the 1932 Adgame Company edition ("Landlord's Game and Prosperity"), published under US Patent 1,509,312 — Magie's second patent. The related 1906 Single Tax rules describe the same underlying philosophy as a process without a named endpoint; Prosperity makes the win condition explicit: the game ends, and all players win collectively, when the poorest player has doubled their starting wealth.

The win condition fundamentally changes incentives. No player can win by bankrupting others — doing so ends the game as a collective loss. Richer players are motivated to assist poorer ones through loans or favourable arrangements, since the collective win is impossible while any player is bankrupt or below their starting wealth.

SETUP

As per the 1906 Commercial Edition.

RULES

As per the 1906 Commercial Edition, with the following change: the win condition is collective rather than individual. No player may be forced into bankruptcy during play. Players may freely assist each other with loans or other arrangements to prevent any player from going bankrupt.

WINNING

The game ends when the player with the least money has doubled their original starting stake. All players win collectively at that point.

Example: in a 3-player game with \$500 starting cash each, the game ends when the player currently holding the least money reaches \$1,000 — regardless of how much the other players hold.

ATTRIBUTION

Prosperity. Named in the Adgame Company edition, 1932, published under US Patent 1,509,312. Designed by Elizabeth J. Magie. Public domain. Sources: Wikipedia: The Landlord's Game (CC-BY-SA) for win condition; landlordsgame.info for 1932 edition context.

THE LANDLORD'S GAME · VARIANT 5 OF 5

Monarch of the World

Circular 40-space track
BOARD

2–6
PLAYERS

MONARCH OF THE WORLD

Monarch of the World is a pedagogical demonstration from the 1906 Economic Game Company edition, not a competitive game. One player takes the role of the Landlord and holds all land from the start; the other players hold every other advantage. The demonstration is designed to prove Magie's central thesis through play: whoever owns all the land is the Monarch of the World, regardless of who controls every other resource.

SETUP

- ♦ One player takes the role of the Landlord and holds all 22 Title Deed cards from the start of the game.
- ♦ All remaining players take all other advantages — houses, utilities, railroads, and Chance cards — and each begin with \$100 in cash.
- ♦ The Landlord receives no wages from MOTHER EARTH and begins with no cash.

RULES

Play proceeds under 1906 Commercial Edition rules with the starting positions above. The Landlord charges rent on every lot space, since they own all lots from the beginning. Other players control all non-land assets — houses, utilities, and railroads — and begin with starting cash.

WINNING

The demonstration is designed to reach a predetermined conclusion. Despite holding no wages and no starting cash, the Landlord collects rent every time another player lands on any lot space — which is every lot on the board. The accumulation of rent income outweighs all other advantages over the course of the game, and the Landlord wins. The game typically runs to its conclusion more quickly than a standard game.

The purpose of the demonstration is to make visible, through play, the Georgist argument that land monopoly is the root cause of economic inequality — that the holder of all land is inevitably the Monarch of the World.

ATTRIBUTION

Monarch of the World. Rules from the Economic Game Company edition, New York, 1906. Designed by Elizabeth J. Magie. Public domain. Source: landlordsgame.info/rules/lg-1906_rulebook.html (transcription via hoelzl/L3 public repository).